

OCBC Bank

Strong insurance income at GE offsets MTM losses; stay UW OCBC into group numbers

GE reported 1Q26 net income of S\$346mn, flat y/y and up 43% from a seasonally weaker 4Q, partly helped by reserve release. OCBC's share of GE profits accounts for 17% of our 1Q26 estimates for the group, higher than 4Q25 (13%) but in line with 1Q25 contribution. Earnings held up despite mark-to-market impact on both insurance business and shareholders' fund. TWNS grew 16% y/y, led by Singapore (+26% y/y), though trends in Malaysia were subdued as GE highlighted challenging business conditions. Strength in TWNS drove 31% y/y improvement in NBEV, helped by better sales mix. Yet, q/q NBEV/TWNS trends were negative, suggesting base effect helping some of the y/y metrics. In Singapore, banca is doing better than agency (+18% q/q vs. -16% q/q), and the OCBC CEO stated that the GE/BoS partnership could be an area of deeper partnership. Post strong banca results at DBS in 1Q ([link](#)), led by private bank, this is one potential area of faster growth at GE/OCBC.

We see limited impact from this set of results on OCBC, where results will be announced pre-market on Friday, May 8. While WM should be strong in 1Q, we expect commentary on capital use to remain growth-focused, which could weigh on the stock in the near-term. Stay UW.

Table 1: GE: 1Q26 Earnings Snapshot

\$mn	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	QoQ	YoY
Total Weighted New Sales	401.9	453.7	373.1	363.5	345.1	-11%	16%
New Business Embedded Value	195.4	241.0	182.2	167.7	148.8	-19%	31%
Profit from Insurance Business	329.0	172.2	228.8	168.4	246.8	91%	33%
Profit from Shareholders' Fund	17.3	69.2	143.2	79.8	98.7	-75%	-82%
Profit Attributable to Shareholders	346.3	241.4	372.0	248.2	345.5	43%	0%

Source: Company data.

Table 2: GE: New Business Embedded Value (NBEV) by market

\$ millions	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	QoQ	YoY
Singapore	118	112	102	67	71	5%	65%
Malaysia	75	127	77	99	75	-41%	0%
Emerging Markets	3	3	3	2	2	12%	26%
Total	195	241	182	168	149	-19%	31%

Source: Company data.

Underweight

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (05 May 26): S\$21.83

Price Target (Jun-27): S\$20.00

APAC Banks

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Table 3: GE: Total Weighted New Sales (TWNS) by market

<i>S\$ millions</i>	1Q26	4Q25	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	QoQ	YoY
SINGAPORE							
Agency	128	151	117	92	102	-16%	25%
Banca	119	101	124	119	94	18%	26%
Others	20	7	11	19	20	200%	2%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	267	259	252	230	216	3%	24%
MALAYSIA							
Agency	94	171	102	113	90	-45%	5%
Banca	4	9	6	5	6	-58%	-35%
Others	29	6	6	9	26	353%	11%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	127	186	113	127	122	-32%	4%
OTHER ASIA							
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	8.3	9	8	7	8	-8%	11%
TOTAL							
Total Weighted New Sales	402	454	373	364	345	-11%	16%

Source: Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$20.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo being the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global being a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating 1.08% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2026E.
- The track-record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 2026. Further, the bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- We expect S\$1 DPS in 2026. This assumes 50% regular payout, as well as pay out of the remaining S\$780mn as special dividend. Beyond FY26, we expect the bank to sustain total payout close to 60%.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. This should support NII, though reduction in credit spreads is a risk given macro uncertainties. We expect 1.77% NIM in FY26 vs. 1.91% in FY25.
- Risk-reward has turned negative following the stock price strength in last 1M. The stock is trading at 1.61x 2026E PB for ~12% ROE.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of S\$20 is based on a fair P/B of 1.3x, assuming a normalized RoE of 11.9%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 10.2% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Further downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5
03-Apr-26	UW	22.38	20

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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